

The Leverage of Enough: A Reflection on Wealth, Want, and Well-Being

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I exist in a fortunate equilibrium, a state defined not by excess but by a carefully cultivated sense of sufficiency. I am neither wealthy in the conventional sense nor am I remotely poor. My financial strength is not liquid; it is strategic, residing in appreciative assets—stocks, investment schemes, and other instruments of quiet growth. This approach has underpinned a life of profound comfort, but its goal has never been wanton accumulation. Rather, it has been to build a foundation, a robust platform from which I can pursue the maximization of my own potential.

This foundation is built on the infrastructure of well-being. I sleep in a comfortable air-conditioned room, a simple luxury that grants the deep, restorative rest necessary for a mind that works relentlessly. I have unrestricted access to excellent nutrition, the ability to enjoy good food and wine without a second thought. My home is a sanctuary engineered for both productivity and leisure. A PlayStation 5, a powerful computer, a projector, and a quality sound system are not mere toys; they are tools for cognitive rejuvenation and narrative immersion, the "play hard" component that refuels the "work hard" ethos.

Because this system of comfort is so reliable, I can afford to push my mind to its absolute limits. After a day of intense intellectual labor, I know I will return to a safe, restorative environment. This security is my greatest leverage. It is a philosophy reflected in my choice of transport: a Royal Enfield Bullet 350, purchased with my own earnings. It is a lifetime motorcycle, an emblem of enduring function over fleeting status. I have no desire to replace it, for it perfectly serves its purpose, much like the other elements of my life.

This sense of security has afforded me a profound feeling of completeness. I have everything I *need*, but I also have everything I truly *want* and *more*. This abundance has shaped my view on money: it is a vital tool up to a point, but its ability to generate happiness follows a law of diminishing returns. I have traveled, experienced luxury, and lived a life rich in experience. The thought of my own mortality does not stir fear, not from arrogance, but from a sense of fulfillment. I am not afraid of loss, because I feel I have already won the experiences that matter most.

My security, however, is not entirely of my own making. I was fortunate to be financially stable throughout my formative years, a period where a child's world was a blend of rigorous study and immense enjoyment. But this personal safety net is fortified by a larger, less visible one: my family. We may not be a household name in Goa, but we are part of a large, extended

network with vast connections—abroad, nationally, and locally, including ties to the political sphere. My father once assured me that should I ever face insurmountable bureaucratic hurdles, he had access to powerful figures who could intervene.

I must be clear: I have no interest in politics or the transactional nature of such connections. The idea of leveraging influence for personal gain, such as securing a job, is antithetical to my principles. When a wealthy acquaintance once suggested I use this leverage to acquire a high-paying professorship, I dismissed it outright. Any position I hold must be earned through my own merit. Yet, I cannot deny this network exists. It is a passive, powerful safety net. Its existence means I can afford to take calculated risks, knowing that an ultimate fallback exists, even if I have no intention of ever using it. It is an unearned privilege, and my responsibility is to build a life that does not depend on it.

As of 2025, while pursuing two master's degrees, I work as a researcher and a personalized home tutor. This tutoring role has provided the final, clarifying piece of my perspective. My clients are, by definition, the very wealthy. This work has become an unintentional anthropological study, granting me an intimate view into the lives of millionaires in homes that resemble modern palaces. I have witnessed a degree of wealth I had never before encountered, and within it, I have often seen a profound and startling misery.

I have sat in drawing rooms that could grace architectural magazines, listening to bitter arguments over property that revealed fractures deep within a family's foundation. I have seen the dysfunction of unhappy personal lives hidden behind lavish interiors, and witnessed the unique tragedy, common in Goa, of families being torn asunder by inheritance disputes. This access has been a powerful education. It has irrevocably confirmed my belief that the accumulation of great wealth, far beyond the point of comfort and security, is not a worthy goal. The "rich life" I value is the one I have already built: one of comfort, security, meaningful work, and the freedom to live without fear. I have the leverage of "enough," and I have seen firsthand the devastating burden of "too much."